

ANNEXURE – IV

Guidelines concerning a statistical definition of informal employment, endorsed by the Seventeenth International Conference of Labour Statisticians (November- December 2003)

The Seventeenth International Conference of Labour Statisticians (ICLS),

Acknowledging that the relevance of informal employment varies among countries, and that a decision to develop statistics on it is therefore determined by national circumstances and priorities,

Noting that the term ‘informal economy’ is used by the ILO as including the informal sector as well as informal employment, and that as a supplement to the System of National Accounts 1993 an international conceptual framework for measurement of the non-observed economy already exists, which distinguishes the informal sector from underground production, illegal production, and household production for own final use,

Recalling the existing international standards on statistics of employment in the informal sector contained in the Resolution concerning statistics of employment in the informal sector adopted by the Fifteenth ICLS (January 1993),

Noting the recommendation made by the Expert Group on Informal Sector Statistics (Delhi Group), during its Fifth Meeting, that the definition and measurement of employment in the informal sector need to be complemented with a definition and measurement of informal employment,

Emphasizing the importance of consistency and coherence in relating the enterprise-based concept of employment in the informal sector to a broader, job-based concept of informal employment,

Considering the methodological work, which the International Labour Office and a number of countries have already undertaken in this area,

Supporting the request, which was made by the International Labour Conference in paragraph 37(n) of the Resolution concerning decent work and the informal economy adopted during its 90th Session (2002), that the International Labour Office should assist countries in the collection, analysis and dissemination of statistics on the informal economy,

Recognizing that the considerable diversity of informal employment situations poses limits to the extent to which statistics on informal employment can be harmonized across countries,

Realizing the usefulness of international guidelines in assisting countries in the development of national definitions of informal employment, and in enhancing the international comparability of the resulting statistics to the extent possible,

Endorses the following guidelines, which complement the Resolution concerning statistics of employment in the informal sector of the Fifteenth ICLS, and encourages countries to test the conceptual framework on which they are based.

1. The concept of informal sector refers to production units as observation units, while the concept of informal employment refers to jobs as observation units. Employment is defined in the sense of paragraph 9 of the Resolution concerning statistics of the economically active population, employment, unemployment and underemployment adopted by the Thirteenth ICLS.

2. *Informal sector enterprises and employment in the informal sector* are defined according to the Resolution concerning statistics of employment in the informal sector adopted by the Fifteenth ICLS. For the purpose of statistics on informal employment, paragraph 19 of the Resolution concerning statistics of employment in the informal sector adopted by the Fifteenth ICLS should be applied to exclude households employing paid domestic workers from informal sector enterprises, and to treat them separately as part of a category named 'households'.

3. (1) *Informal employment* comprises the total number of informal jobs as defined in subparagraphs (2) to (5) below, whether carried out in formal sector enterprises, informal sector enterprises, or households, during a given reference period.

(2) As shown in the attached matrix, informal employment includes the following types of jobs:

- (i) own-account workers employed in their own informal sector enterprises (cell 3);
- (ii) employers employed in their own informal sector enterprises (cell 4);
- (iii) contributing family workers, irrespective of whether they work in formal or informal sector enterprises (cells 1 and 5);
- (iv) members of informal producers' cooperatives (cell 8);
- (v) employees holding informal jobs (as defined in subparagraph (5) below) in formal sector enterprises, informal sector enterprises, or as paid domestic workers employed by households (cells 2, 6 and 10);
- (vi) own-account workers engaged in the production of goods exclusively for own final use by their household (cell 9), if considered employed according to paragraph 9 (6) of the

Resolution concerning statistics of the economically active population, employment, unemployment and underemployment adopted by the Thirteenth ICLS.

- (3) Own-account workers, employers, members of producers' cooperatives, contributing family workers, and employees are defined in accordance with the latest version of the International Classification of Status in Employment (ICSE).
 - (4) Producers' cooperatives are considered informal, if they are not formally established as legal entities and also meet the other criteria of informal sector enterprises specified in the Resolution concerning statistics of employment in the informal sector adopted by the Fifteenth ICLS.
 - (5) Employees are considered to have informal jobs if their employment relationship is, in law or in practice, not subject to national labour legislation, income taxation, social protection or entitlement to certain employment benefits (advance notice of dismissal, severance pay, paid annual or sick leave, etc.). The reasons may be the following: non-declaration of the jobs or the employees; casual jobs or jobs of a limited short duration; jobs with hours of work or wages below a specified threshold (e.g. for social security contributions); employment by unincorporated enterprises or by persons in households; jobs where the employee's place of work is outside the premises of the employer's enterprise (e.g. outworkers without employment contract); or jobs, for which labour regulations are not applied, not enforced, or not complied with for any other reason. The operational criteria for defining informal jobs of employees are to be determined in accordance with national circumstances and data availability.
 - (6) For purposes of analysis and policy-making, it may be useful to disaggregate the different types of informal jobs listed in paragraph 3 (2) above, especially those held by employees. Such a typology and definitions should be developed as part of further work on classifications by status in employment at the international and national levels.
4. Where they exist, employees holding formal jobs in informal sector enterprises (cell 7 of the attached matrix) should be excluded from informal employment.
5. *Informal employment outside the informal sector* comprises the following types of jobs:
- (i) employees holding informal jobs (as defined in paragraph 3 (5) above) in formal sector enterprises (cell 2) or as paid domestic workers employed by households (cell 10);
 - (ii) contributing family workers working in formal sector enterprises (cell 1);
 - (iii) own-account workers engaged in the production of goods exclusively for own final use by their household (cell 9), if considered employed according to paragraph 9 (6)

of the Resolution concerning statistics of the economically active population, employment, unemployment and underemployment adopted by the Thirteenth ICLS.

6. Countries, which do not have statistics on employment in the informal sector, or for which a classification of employment by type of production unit is not relevant, may develop statistics on informal employment, if desired, in specifying appropriate definitions of informal jobs of own-account workers, employers and members of producers' cooperatives. Alternatively, they may limit the measurement of informal employment to employee jobs.

7. Countries, which exclude agricultural activities from the scope of their informal sector statistics, should develop suitable definitions of informal jobs in agriculture, especially with respect to jobs held by own-account workers, employers and members of producers' cooperatives.

Conceptual Framework: Informal Employment

Production units by type	Jobs by status in employment								
	Own-account workers		Employers		Contributing family workers	Employees		Members of producers' cooperatives	
	Informal	Formal	Informal	Formal	Informal	Informal	Formal	Informal	Formal
Formal sector enterprises					1	2			
Informal sector enterprises (a)	3		4		5	6	7	8	
Households ^(b)	9					10			

(a) As defined by the Fifteenth International Conference of Labour Statisticians (excluding households employing paid domestic workers).

(b) Households producing goods exclusively for their own final use and households employing paid domestic workers.

Note: Cells shaded in dark grey refer to jobs, which, by definition, do not exist in the type of production unit in question. Cells shaded in light grey refer to formal jobs. Un-shaded cells represent the various types of informal jobs.

Informal employment:

Cells 1 to 6 and 8 to 10.

Employment in the informal sector:

Cells 3 to 8.

Informal employment outside the informal sector:

Cells 1, 2, 9 and 10.



Five Year Vision

2019-2024



Data for Development

Government of India
Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
Sardar Patel Bhawan,
New Delhi

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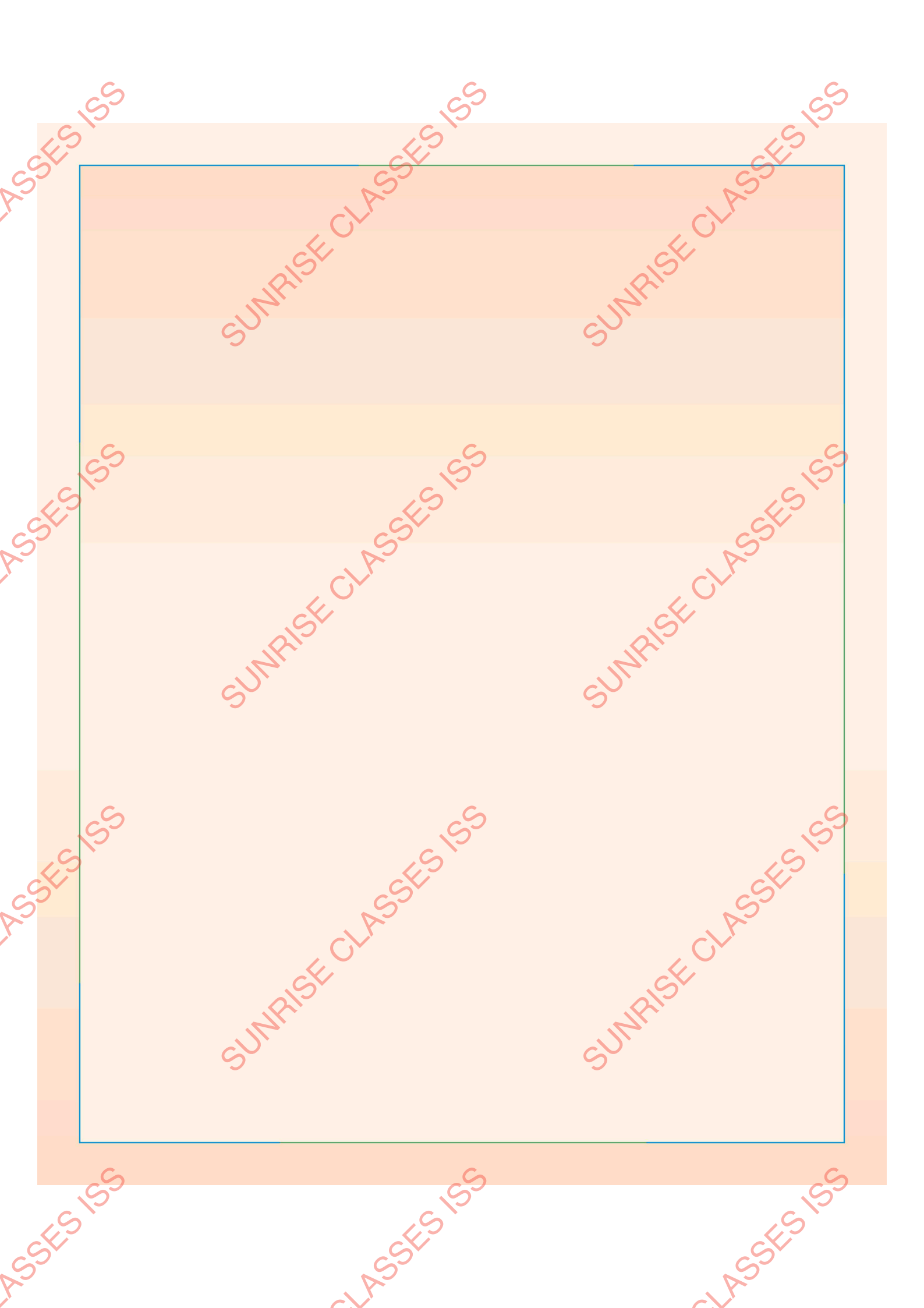
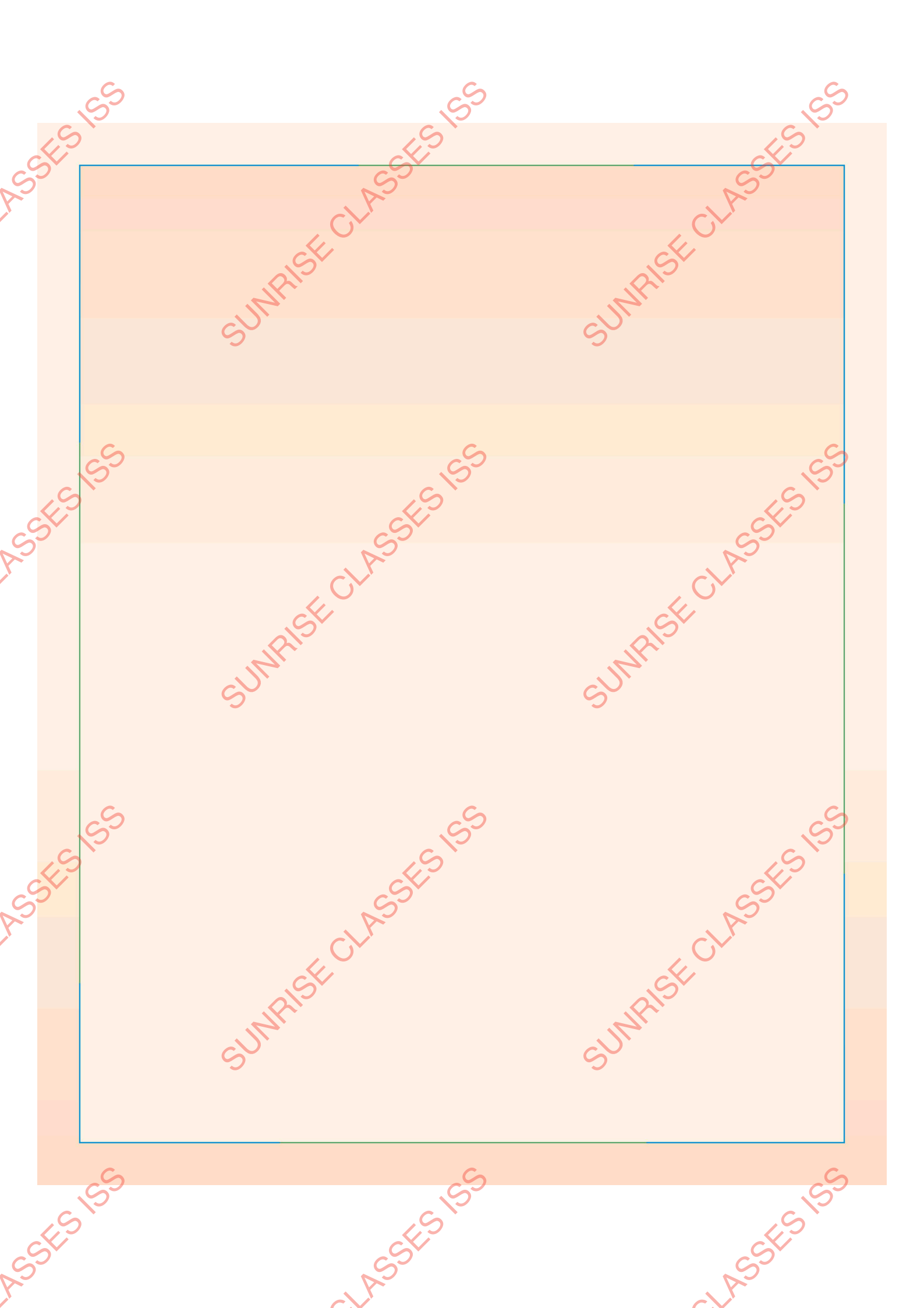


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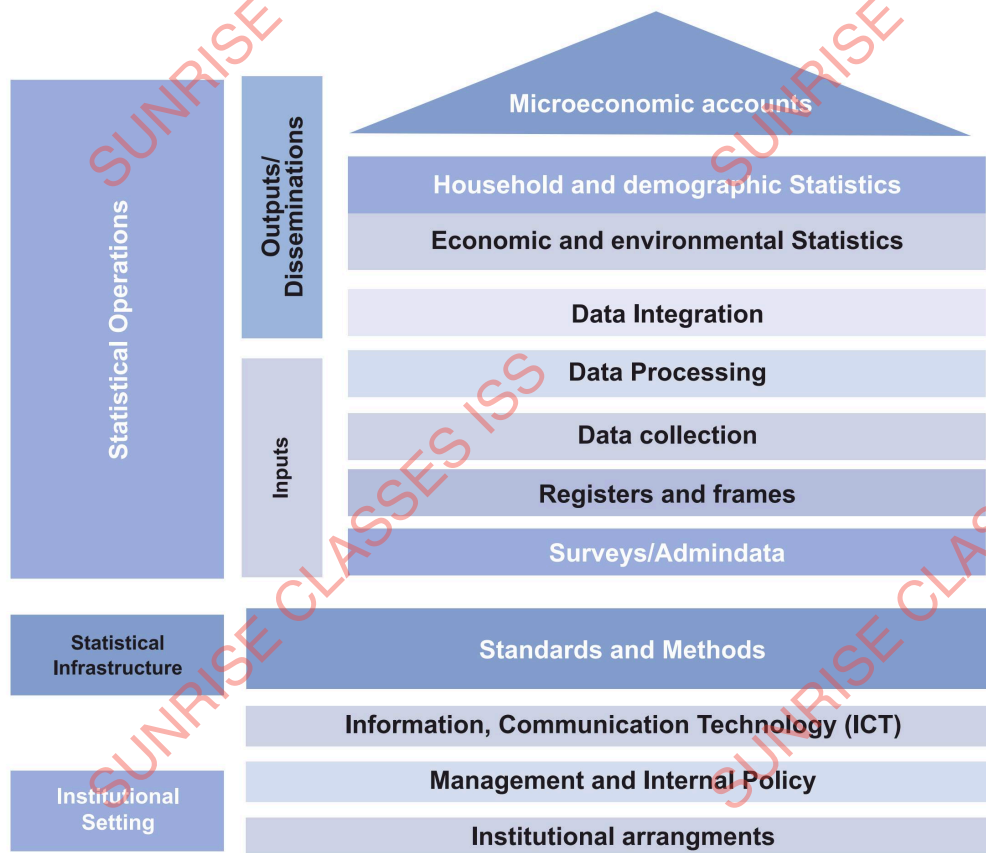


Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Five Year Vision (2019- 2024) Document

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation - Vision 2024
“Strengthen India’s national statistical system to provide real-time inputs for policy and stronger dissemination practices for public.”

Integrated Statistics Approach



Chapter - I

A. Backdrop for Transformation of National Statistical System

1.1 The primary aim of official statistics system is to provide timely, reliable and comprehensive data in order to facilitate evidence-based decision making towards policy formulation, monitoring, evaluation and recommendations for further improvement. In the Indian context, the official statistics system is laterally decentralized among various Ministries of the Government of India (GOI) at the central level, and vertically decentralized, between the Centre and the States.

1.2 **The National Statistical Office (NSO)**, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is the nodal agency for planning and facilitating the integrated development of the national statistical system. It plays a crucial role in responding to the emerging and evolving information/ data needs on a wide range of socio-economic-demographic issues. NSO lays down and maintains norms and standards in the field of official statistics, evolving concepts, definitions, classifications and methodologies of data collection, processing of data and release of results. It also coordinates statistical activities amongst Ministries/Departments of the Government of India as well as with the State Governments to improve the quality of statistical processes and products, identifying gaps in data availability or duplication of statistical work and suggesting remedial measures, and reducing time-lag in bringing out various statistical products. NSO also advises the Central Ministries / Departments and State Governments on statistical matters and activities in laying down statistical standards, conducting sample surveys, censuses and improving administrative statistics. In addition, the Programme Implementation (PI) Wing of MoSPI, reviews the progress of Central Sector Infrastructure Projects costing Rs. 150 crore and above for time and cost overruns and also implements the Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS).

1.3 Countries around the world are embarking on significant modernization of their national statistical systems in the face of rapid major technological and socio-economic changes. In line with these changes, official statistical landscape is becoming more complex, expectations of policy makers are increasing exponentially, and the system is challenged to deliver best possible statistics in more efficient and innovative ways. This holds true for National Statistical System of India also. As Official Statistics are produced within the governmental system, these are considered as public goods, and thus it is imperative that they comply with certain basic principles, such as professional independence, impartiality, accountability and transparency about methods of collection and dissemination of statistics. These principles are enshrined in the United Nations Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics, adopted by the UN General Assembly in January, 2014. India adopted these Principles is through a Cabinet Resolution in May, 2016.

1.4 India is at the cusp of a new phase of socio-economic transformation. Increased penetration of digital technologies has brought about transparency and efficiency in the Government functioning and is improving these of living of citizens. As a result, the amount of information available is increasing exponentially and with improved access to the public. Initiatives under Digital India have transformed the e-government landscape with the introduction of world-class digital services. The flow of data from these new services enables the government to harness new and timely data sources for decision support. The central and state governments are rapidly intensifying their efforts to harness these new sources of data. Policy makers need to not only track the progress of various Government programmes but also get a better picture of their impact and outcomes to effect mid-course corrections, which are now becoming possible with the advancements in technology. This has catalysed the dissemination, and consumption of data which are taking place at an unprecedented pace. These developments provide a new opportunity for the national statistical system to align and converge the information flow across varied sources so that an integrated picture emerges for more effective and timely policy interventions.

1.5 In this backdrop of the **Industrial Revolution 4.0** driven by the digital data revolution, the National Statistical System needs to be geared up for meeting the contemporary demands of society and policy makers. The statistical products need to become more reliable, easy to understand and be easily accessible. The Government's initiatives for achieving USD 5 Trillion economy requires real time monitoring of multi-dimensional parameters of economy. The National Statistical System thus needs to play a continuous and proactive role in providing objective and improved metrics for measuring the development of the economy, society and environment.

1.6 The Indian statistical system is not alone in this transformation journey and it joins many other developing and developed countries in modernising their statistical systems to leverage this opportunity and simultaneously evolve to meet the data demands for the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Fulfilment under SDG commitment also places new demands on the need for quality data and statistics, disaggregated by location, sex, age, income group and other dimensions of development. MoSPI is taking the lead to respond to these demands with timely and robust official statistics for addressing these priorities.

1.7 In the decentralised statistical framework, MoSPI seeks to align its activities to address the high priority information needs of the country for evidence-based policy making and good governance in India while maintaining the credibility of the national statistical system.

B. International Best Practices for National Statistical Systems

2.1 The United Nations and its specialised agencies bring out various guidelines and standards that the National Statistical Offices in member countries can adapt to their specific needs and requirements. In addition, MoSPI has been separately pursuing the ISO:9000 certifications for its statistical processes, and presently, the National Accounts Division, the Price Statistics Division and the Survey Design and Research Division of NSO are ISO:9000 certified. The Ministry has also notified the National Quality Assurance Framework in April, 2018 to be voluntarily administered by statistical offices in India to get a self-assessment score on their quality processes. This is based on the **United Nations Quality Assurance Framework**. The Sustainable Development Goals adopted by the UN General Assembly provides a vibrant platform for integration of statistical systems both nationally and internationally and will be leveraged appropriately.

2.2 The UN has also brought out the “**Guidelines on Integrated Economic Statistics**” which guides countries in preparing a set of integrated economic statistics in response to the need for a consistent framework for measuring the country's economic activity, especially in an increasingly interconnected global economy. Integrated economic statistics provide a consistent and reliable assessment of a country's economic activity for policy and analytical uses. This assumes all the more significance when countries are required to monitor the progress of achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

2.3 Integrated economic statistics are a set of economic statistics that depict a consistent and coherent picture of economic activities for policy, business and other analytical uses. The integration of economic statistics is about the use of common concepts, definitions, estimation methods and data sources for statistical reconciliation. In today's global context, the users of the statistical services ask for more and better statistics, and the statistical service providers need to be proactive in satisfying the increasing user needs for integrated economic data. In addition, a number of recent emerging initiatives on the measurement of sustainability, social progress and well-being have raised the need for integrated and coherent official statistics to shed light on those complex issues, and therefore pose challenges to statistical offices to produce integrated economic, environmental and socio-demographic statistics. The development of such integrated and multidimensional statistics requires developing the capacity to integrate the production of relevant statistics.

2.4 The motivation for **integrated economic statistics** comes from the benefits that these statistics provide for coordinated national and global policy initiatives in an increasingly interconnected world. The motivation is relevant for all countries, independent of their level of development of statistical systems and national economies.

The integration is achievable for small and comprehensive national economic data sets and can be progressively introduced into the national statistical system.

2.5 The approach for transformation in MoSPI would be on the lines of the broad recommendations of the UN ECE High-level Group for the Modernisation of Official Statistics (MOS), by adapting the framework to the Indian context. The framework includes the following components:

a) **Generic Statistical Business Process Model (GSBPM)** – This model describes the core business processes undertaken by statistical organizations to produce statistical outputs. It can help statistical organisations to find common processes across organisations to reduce inefficiency and redundancy.

b) **Generic Statistical Information Model (GSIM)** – This model describes the core pieces of information needed by statistical organizations to produce statistical outputs. It gives a common language to describe the information that flows in and out of GSBPM processes.

c) **Common Statistical Production Architecture (CSPA)** – CSPA provides an overarching framework for statistical organisations to more easily share and reuse methods, statistical models, implemented methods and implemented services.

d) **Generic Activity Model for Statistical Organisations (GAMSO)** - This model describes the activities that take place within a typical statistical organization. It extends and complements GSBPM by adding overarching processes needed to support statistical production.

The transformational framework, when implemented, will facilitate soft integration of data silos existing in the system through meta-data mapping across systems including soft integration of statistical registries.

2.6 Critical pillars to this transformation are not only the technological interventions but also the management of human capital for the statistical framework being put in place. Innovative techniques will be evolved for exploiting new data sources and will require involvement of research and other institutions so that new ideas can be crowd sourced, incubated and developed for use in the national statistical system.

C. The National Statistical System - Vision 2024

3. The Vision 2024 for the National Statistical System, spearheaded by MoSPI, derives from the fact that official statistics is a public good and an essential part of development infrastructure. MoSPI will play a crucial role in coordinating and harmonizing the metadata for statistical products available in the country using technological interventions. The Vision 2024 has been formulated to provide a holistic, coherent and comprehensive framework for improving the national statistical system, thereby delivering official statistics in the country in a reliable and sustainable manner. It also aims to bridge the identified data gaps by providing data on a real time basis via user-friendly platforms to Government and other stakeholders with extensive use of technology for the statistical products and processes. The reform measures will address the institutional, organizational and technical challenges being faced in the present system. The five-year vision of MoSPI is envisaged as:

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation - Vision 2024

“Strengthen India's national statistical system to provide real-time inputs for policy and stronger dissemination practices for public.”

D. National Statistical System - Transformational Themes

4.1 National statistical system is operating in a dynamic environment with new opportunities for and challenges in accessing and integrating vast amount of data becoming available. Real time access to data to monitor the performance of economy by the policy makers is of paramount importance to identify early signs for triggering mid-course corrections and facilitate identification of optimal ways and means to respond. The national statistical system is therefore required to keep pace with the rapidly changing nature of economy and society. A credible statistical system requires statistical production processes that can produce high quality and timely statistics that meet the needs of varied users.

4.2 Equally important, official statistics need to produce statistics with a high-level of professional independence. Countries that are undergoing transformation have responded by (a) changing policy, legal and governance arrangements that shaped their statistical systems; and (b) modernizing the operations of their statistical offices and adjusting the type of statistical outputs produced to meet the needs of their rapidly changing economies.

4.3 Government is the custodian of vast repository of administrative, survey, institutional and transaction data. Such data is termed as '**Administrative Statistics**' which is essentially data collected by Government at different levels through its instrumentalities, largely as a by-product of administering specific legislation,

like MCA, GSTN etc. Administrative data collected by various Government agencies are not being optimally utilized since much of these datasets are dispersed across different Government institutions and agencies. These agencies also maintain multiple registries for collection and compilation of data in silos. For each indicator of social welfare, responsibility to gather data lies with the corresponding Central or State Government institution and each has defined its own Metadata standards, where Metadata is structured minimal information that describes, explains, locates or otherwise makes it easier to retrieve, use or manage an information resource. Some of the e-governance projects do follow the Metadata and Data Standards (MDDS) coordinated by Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). However, in general, data gathered by a Government agency is maintained separately from that gathered by another. Integrating the information across the data sets will be extremely useful for policy makers to monitor various interventions and programmes on a real time basis for effecting mid-course corrections. Such integrated data is more valuable than isolated data sets being maintained by various agencies.

4.4 These watertight data sets create a large amount of duplicate data, have an increased pressure on virtual data storage and potentially clog the digital ecosystem. There exists no common database of registries across beneficiary schemes at the national level to facilitate the policy makers about the actual number of beneficiaries. Similarly, data relating to financial sector, establishment and enterprises are also unconnected and dispersed across the Government Institutions.

4.5 Integration of data existing in silos is an imperative need for the evolving socio-economic landscape of the country. Enabling sharing of information and access to data sets would improve the implementation of Government welfare schemes, empower people to make better decisions and democratize an important public good. Since databases have slowly become on-line within the Central and State Governments, they offer a new opportunity to build a sound national data infrastructure for future governance. This will also enable interoperability of the data sets in digital and portable formats.

4.6 In order to embrace new opportunities of the data revolution, effective R&D and innovation are essential elements in every part of the statistical system. During the next five years, MoSPI aims to develop and implement pioneering ways to respond to the unmet statistical needs using innovative, efficient and effective methods. MoSPI will facilitate greater use and linkage usage of administrative data in the day to day functioning of Government. Using new technologies and identifying and exploiting methods, MoSPI through its concerted interaction with stakeholders intends to achieve a major change in the sharing of data within and beyond Government for statistical purposes. Similarly, access to data to public will be made in a user-friendly manner.

Government for statistical purposes. Similarly, access to data to public will be made in a user-friendly manner.

4.7 MoSPI, as the nodal agency for the national statistical system, appreciates the need to integrate these data silos and their analytics, management and dissemination by optimally utilizing digital technologies. Since the data systems have been in operation for a significant time, it is not feasible for retro-fitting metadata standards onto running systems. The approach would be to have a soft mapping of the metadata and facilitate a **Data-Lake architecture** that will provide useful insights to various aspects of the Indian economy, which may not be feasible through manual systems.

4.8 Strengthening data dissemination requires an emphasis on both timely dissemination of data assets in user-friendly formats and improvement in communication of statistics. MoSPI is already giving access to unit level data along with relevant metadata of its various socio-economic surveys. MoSPI also plans to strengthen its communication mechanism with the stakeholders and build expertise in strategic communication and brand management, media relations, content creation, website management, stakeholder engagement, social media, digital media and data visualization. Communication and user engagement will be improved by greater use of info graphics and videos, and dynamic visualizations to highlight insightful trends and concepts relating to commonly used indicators. MoSPI will explore innovative ways of making data, statistics and analysis more accessible, easier to understand and support accurate and meaningful interpretation. Statistical products of MoSPI will be made available to users in open format for re-use while protecting the confidentiality of personal information.

4.9 In the above backdrop, over the next five years, MoSPI will implement wide-ranging reforms of statistical products and processes to realize its vision. This reform process will focus on the following broad themes:

Theme I: Strengthening statistical infrastructure for real-time monitoring of the economy.

Theme II: Integrating data and registries, existing in silos in various Ministries, into the National Statistical System through an Integrated Information Portal by developing data sharing protocols and use of technology

Theme III: Strengthening the monitoring of large infrastructure projects

4.10 The themes for reforms will be based on the **UN Generic Statistical Business Process Model (GSBPM)**, **Generic Statistical Information Model (GSIM)**, **Common Statistical Production Architecture (CSPA)** and the **Generic Activity Model for Statistical Organisations (GAMSO)**, after adaptation to the Indian context (para2.5 above refers).

E. National Statistical System - Transformational Strategies

5.1 The statistical reform initiatives being undertaken by MoSPI will be achieved through a Mission Mode approach with aggressive timelines for repositioning itself to be at the vanguard for providing data for Government policies and interventions. MoSPI has identified key drivers for reinvigorating the National Statistical System for data driven interventions for measuring the progress of the Government's goal of achieving USD 5 trillion economy by 2024 and with enhanced ease of living. These drivers are based on the following strategies

Strategy I: Strengthening Institutional Framework

Strategy II: Strengthening Technological and Physical Infrastructure

Strategy III: Effective Human Capital Management

5.2 The motivation for transformation of the statistical products and processes will be the **UN Generic Statistical Business Process Model (GSBPM)**, illustrated in the Figure. There are more than 50 developing and developed countries that have adopted this model in conjunction with other transformational models to improve efficiency and relevance in national statistical operations.

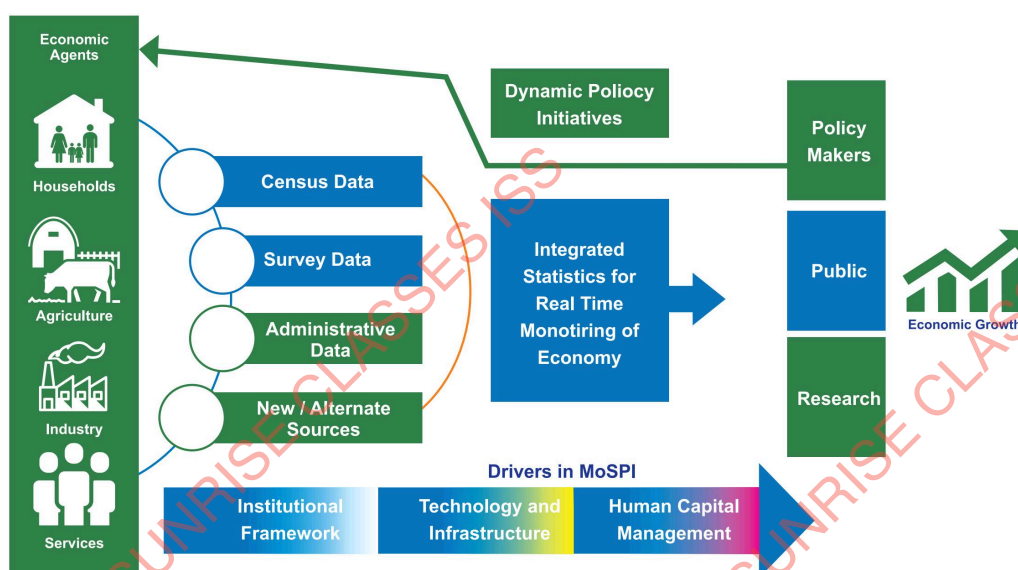
Figure 5.1: UN Generic Statistical Business Process Model (GSBPM)



5.3 The above GSBPM model can be adapted to the Indian context to transform the national statistical landscape for **real-time monitoring** of the Indian economy, as illustrated in Figure 5.2 below. It needs to be appreciated that the Ministry has already taken several steps under the GSBPM Model, albeit in an isolated manner and confined to Division specific activities. The effort now would be to bring the transformational processes in line with the global best practices using this model as a framework.

Figure 5.2: Integrated Statistics for Real Time Monitoring of the Indian Economy

Real-Time of Monitoring of Economy



5.4 It may be seen that the thrust of the transformation is not merely focussed on improved statistical operations in census, surveys and administrative data, which are traditional sources of statistical information. In fact, **new/alternate data sources** emanating from Big Data have potential to come with lower cost and can lead to more timely and granular statistics. However, there are still issues that hinder exploiting such data, such as potential of bias, coverage, uncertainty about accuracy of user-generated contents, difficulty of coordination with data holders, privacy regulations and social license. These need to be addressed through an effective policy framework.

F: National Statistical System – Implementation Approach

6.1 The implementation framework to achieve Vision 2024 of MoSPI will involve mobilizing critical drivers of transformation including institutional, legal and policy framework, IT strategy, Human Capital Management, creating quality consciousness, innovation and R&D, and enhanced user engagement with appropriate dissemination strategy.

Strategy I: Strengthening Institutional Framework

6.2 Several initiatives had been taken in the past by MoSPI for reforming the national statistical system including those in pursuance of the recommendations of National Statistical Commission headed by Dr. C. Rangarajan (2000-2001). These, inter-alia, include setting up of **National Statistical Commission (NSC)** as an apex advisory body on statistical matters, enacting **Collection of Statistics Act, 2008**, adopting international standards of data collection and dissemination in the field of national accounts, price statistics, industrial statistics, designing **National Indicator Framework (NIF)** for monitoring the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, monitoring of large scale central sector infrastructure projects, providing technical support to States/ UTs in evolving their own statistical products, financial assistance to States/ UTs for improving their statistical systems, capacity building in official statistics etc. India has also adopted **United Nations Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics (UNFPOS)** recognising official statistics as public goods which needs to comply with certain basic principles, such as professional independence, impartiality, accountability and transparency about methods of collection, compilation and dissemination.

6.3 In spite of continuous efforts made by the statistical agencies in India to improve their systems, certain systemic deficiencies persist like the existence of gaps in availability of required information; delays in publication of results; periodic revision of released indicators; discrepancies between official statistics from different sources; transparency in statistical operations; availability of trained manpower and financial resources. These deficiencies have implications on the credibility of official statistics, particularly in a decentralised system. The existing institutional arrangements and legal framework need to be reinforced to cope with the increased requirements of data and for monitoring the health of the economy on a real time basis. In this direction, MoSPI aims to further strengthen the official statistical system by taking transformative measures in the existing institutional, legal and policy framework to ensure that access to reliable official statistics is equitable and free, and promotes the widest possible use of official statistics for the economic development agenda.

I.A National Policy on Official Statistics

6.4 The Government of India adopted **UN Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics** in 2016 with a view to promote good practices and professional ethics in production and dissemination of Official Statistics in the country. These principles are expected to benefit decision makers, statisticians, data providers and users in various ways and instil public trust in Official Statistical System and honour citizens' and